

Training Request Process Improvement

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Business Context

Fictionalized case study based on my professional experience coordinating end-to-end corporate training initiatives. Company-specific information has been generalized or removed.

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role in the Process
Requesting Manager	Identifies the learning need and submits the training request
Department Head	Reviews and confirms the learning need
L&D Team	Assesses, coordinates and manages the training process
Trainer / External Training Provider	Delivers the training and may provide post-training observations or feedback
Participants	Attend the training and provide participant feedback

Inputs & Outputs

Inputs	Outputs
Training request	Confirmed learning solution
Learning objectives	Scheduled training
Participant information	Training delivered
Approvals	Attendance record
Budget information	Feedback / outcomes
Trainer availability	Closed request

AS-IS Process

Process Steps

1. Learning need identified by a manager.
2. Learning need discussed with the Department Head.
3. Learning request communicated to the L&D Team.
4. Request assigned to an L&D team member.
5. Initial needs assessment — clarify the target group, number of participants, business/learning goal and required approvals.
6. Determine the appropriate learning solution — e.g. training, workshop, facilitation or coaching.
7. Assign an internal trainer where applicable.

8. Identify external trainer/coaching support if the required expertise is not available internally.
9. Select trainer / learning provider.
10. Confirm participants, timing and scope with relevant stakeholders.
11. Confirm budget / required approvals.
12. Schedule the training session.
13. Organize logistics — room or online setup, Teams access, equipment, catering and materials.
14. Communicate training details to participants and relevant stakeholders.
15. Confirm participant attendance and send manual reminders.
16. Prepare training materials and session setup.
17. Deliver the training / workshop / session.
18. Record attendance and ensure required materials are available to participants.
19. Provide optional post-training support for participants, including follow-up questions.
20. Conduct trainer/team debrief.
21. Discuss observations and lessons learned.
22. Report outcomes and recommendations to the requesting manager.
23. Close the training request.

Decisions & Exceptions

#	Decision/Exception	Yes/Normal Path	No/Alternate Path
1	Can the need be addressed internally?	Assign internal trainer	Request external support
2	Is solution approved?	Continue with preparation	Propose alternative solution
3	Are all required approvals available?	Continue planning	Obtain required approval
4	Is post-training support needed?	Organize additional session	Conduct follow-up

AS-IS Process Model

BPMN model available as a separate file in the project repository.

Process Analysis

N r	Area	AS-IS Observation	Problem/Risk	Process Impact	Improvement Opportunity
1	Requirements	The learning request may initially contain only a general need, e.g. "We need training."	The actual business need may not be clearly defined.	Risk of selecting a solution that does not address the underlying problem.	Introduce a standardized request form / requirements checklist.
2	Requirements	L&D needs to additionally clarify the objective, target group, number of participants and scope.	Key information is collected during the process rather than upfront.	Additional communication and potential delays.	Capture key requirements at the initial request stage.
3	Decision-making	Internal capabilities are checked first, followed by external providers if required.	Selecting the appropriate solution requires several sequential steps.	Potentially longer request handling time.	Define clear criteria for selecting an internal vs. external solution.
4	Rework	The initially requested solution may prove unsuitable after the need is clarified.	The process may need to return to an earlier stage and reconsider the solution.	Additional work for L&D and stakeholders.	Conduct a structured needs assessment before organizing a specific solution.
5	Stakeholder communication	Several stakeholder groups are involved: manager, department lead, L&D, trainer/provider and participants.	Information needs to be passed between multiple parties.	Risk of incomplete or inconsistent information.	Define process ownership and standard communication points.
6	Ownership	The request moves from the manager through the department lead to L&D	Ownership of the next action may not always be explicit.	Potential waiting time between activities.	Clearly assign ownership for each process stage.
7	Approvals	Relevant approvals and budget confirmation may be required before delivery.	The process may stop while waiting for approval.	Delayed start of the organization process.	Define required approvals and when they need to be obtained.
8	Scheduling	Scheduling requires coordination between the trainer, manager and participants.	Multiple dependencies affect the choice of date.	Longer planning time.	Establish standard planning and availability rules.
9	Logistics	Room / Teams setup, equipment, materials and other logistical	Multiple elements require	Risk of missing an item and additional	Introduce a standardized pre-training checklist.

		elements need to be checked before training.	manual verification.	administrative work.	
10	Participant management	Participants need to be confirmed, informed and reminded about the training.	Attendance requires additional communication.	Administrative workload and potential attendance issues.	Use automated reminders / a centralized participant list.
11	Information flow	Training information is communicated to participants before the session.	Information may be spread across multiple messages	Participants may not have all required information in one place.	Use a standardized communication template / central information source.
12	Pre-training preparation	The trainer/L&D team performs final checks of materials, room and setup.	Issues may only be identified shortly before the session.	Additional last-minute work or disruption risk.	Introduce a checklist and deadline for final verification.
13	Delivery	Training is delivered only after multiple preceding activities have been completed.	Issues earlier in the process can directly affect delivery.	Risk of disruption or rescheduling.	Introduce a clear “ready for delivery” checkpoint.
14	Post-training support	Participants may receive additional support and follow-up after the training.	Follow-up is not always formally structured.	Difficult to monitor whether the learning need was fully addressed.	Introduce a standardized follow-up process.
15	Lessons learned	A trainer/team debrief is conducted and observations are identified after the session.	Lessons learned may remain within informal team communication.	Knowledge may not be consistently reused for future initiatives.	Introduce a standardized lessons-learned record.
16	Reporting	L&D reports outcomes and recommendations to the requesting manager.	Reporting may depend on the individual managing the request.	More difficult to compare initiatives consistently.	Introduce a standardized outcome report.
17	Data / tracking	The process generates information about requests, participants, dates, trainers and outcomes.	Data may be stored across different locations.	More difficult monitoring and historical analysis.	Introduce a centralized process tracker.
18	Process standardization	Activities follow an established way of working, but some steps depend on the individual request.	Similar requests may be handled slightly differently.	Reduced consistency and scalability.	Define a standard workflow with clearly documented exceptions.

Key findings

Priority	Finding	Why it matters
1	Incomplete requirements at the start	Can lead to choosing the wrong learning solution and creating rework.
2	Manual stakeholder communication	Creates coordination effort and increases the risk of missing or inconsistent information.
3	Unclear ownership and multiple dependencies	Can create waiting time and make it unclear who needs to act next.
4	Manual pre-training checks and logistics	Creates administrative workload and increases the risk of last-minute issues.
5	Unstructured lessons learned	Valuable knowledge may not be captured and reused systematically

TO-BE Process

Process Steps

1. Learning need identified by a manager.
2. Learning need discussed with the Department Head.
3. Learning request submitted to the L&D Team through the standard training request form.
4. Request assigned to an L&D process owner.
5. Initial needs assessment — clarify the target group, number of participants, business/learning goal and required approvals.
6. Determine the appropriate learning solution — e.g. training, workshop, facilitation or coaching.
7. Check internal trainer availability and competencies.
8. Request external trainer/coaching support if the required expertise is not available internally.
9. Select trainer / learning provider and confirm availability.
10. Confirm required approvals.
11. Schedule the training session and update the database.
12. Organize logistics — room or online setup, Teams access, equipment, catering and materials.
13. Automatically send training details to participants and relevant stakeholders.
14. Confirm participant attendance and send automated reminders.
15. Prepare training materials and session setup.
16. Complete the pre-training checklist and verify readiness; resolve identified issues before delivery.
17. Deliver the training / workshop / session.
18. Record attendance and make required materials available to participants.
19. Provide optional post-training support for participants, including follow-up questions.
20. Conduct trainer/team debrief.
21. Document observations and lessons learned.

22. Identify improvements for future sessions.
23. Report outcomes and recommendations to the requesting manager.
24. Close the training request and update the training database.

Decisions & Exceptions

#	Decision/Exception	Yes/Normal Path	No/Alternate Path
1	Are requirements complete?	Assign team member	Request missing information
2	Can the need be addressed internally?	Assign internal trainer	Request external support
3	Is solution approved?	Continue with preparation	Propose alternative solution
4	Are all required approvals available?	Continue planning	Obtain required approval
5	Is everything ready?	Continue preparation	Resolve issue
6	Is post-training support needed?	Provide follow-up support	Continue closure activities

TO-BE Process Model

BPMN model available as a separate file in the project repository.

Process Improvements

AS-IS Finding	TO-BE Improvement
Incomplete requirements	Centralized Training Request Form
Manual stakeholder communication	Standardized communication + central request record
Unclear ownership and multiple dependencies	Clearly assigned process owner + central status tracking
Manual pre-training checks	Standardized pre-training checklist
Unstructured lessons learned	Standardized post-training feedback & lessons-learned record

Requirements

Requirements Overview

Requirements were derived from the identified AS-IS process issues and the proposed TO-BE process. They focus on reducing manual communication, improving request completeness and ownership, increasing process visibility, and standardizing preparation and follow-up activities.

Business Requirements

ID	Business Requirement	Related problem
BR-01	Training requests should contain all required information before they are reviewed by L&D.	Incomplete requirements
BR-02	The process should have clear ownership from request intake through closure.	Unclear ownership
BR-03	Training-related communication should be standardized at key points in the process.	Manual/scattered communication
BR-04	Training preparation should be supported by a standardized checklist.	Manual pre-training checks
BR-05	Training requests should have a central record with clear status tracking.	Scattered tracking
BR-06	Participant reminders should be standardized and automated where possible.	Manual reminders
BR-07	Training outcomes and lessons learned should be documented consistently.	Unstructured follow-up
BR-08	The process should provide a clear mechanism for handling incomplete requests.	Rework / missing information

Functional Requirements

ID	Functional Requirement	Related BR
FR-01	The request should contain mandatory fields for target group, number of participants, learning objective, preferred timing and required approvals.	BR-01
FR-02	The request should prevent submission when mandatory information is missing.	BR-01
FR-03	L&D should be notified when a previously incomplete training request is updated by the requester.	BR-01
FR-04	Each training request should have an assigned L&D process owner.	BR-02
FR-05	The process owner should remain responsible for coordinating the request until closure.	BR-02
FR-06	Standardized communication templates must be available for key stakeholder and participant communications.	BR-03
FR-07	Key stakeholders must be informed at defined points of the training request lifecycle and about significant changes.	BR-03

FR-08	Each training request must have a central record containing its current status, owner, key dates and relevant documentation.	BR-05
FR-09	The request status must be updated at defined process milestones, e.g. Submitted, Under Review, Awaiting Approval, Scheduled, Delivered and Closed.	BR-05
FR-10	L&D must complete a standardized pre-training checklist before the training takes place.	BR-04
FR-11	The checklist must cover training logistics, room/online setup, equipment, materials, participant list and trainer readiness.	BR-04
FR-12	Participants must receive standardized information about the training, including date, time, location/online access and relevant preparation details.	BR-06
FR-13	Automated reminders should be sent to participants before the scheduled training.	BR-06
FR-14	Participant feedback must be collected after the training.	BR-07
FR-15	Training outcomes and relevant observations must be documented after delivery.	BR-07
FR-16	Lessons learned and improvement opportunities must be recorded in a standardized format.	BR-07
FR-17	Incomplete training requests must be returned to the requester with information about the missing data required for further processing.	BR-08
FR-18	Outstanding preparation issues must be resolved and the training must pass the final readiness check before delivery.	BR-04

User Stories

ID	User	Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-01	Requesting Manager	As a Requesting Manager, I want to submit a complete training request so that L&D can assess the need without additional clarification.	1. Given the manager is submitting a training request when all mandatory fields are completed, then the request can be submitted to L&D. 2. Given one or more mandatory fields are missing, when the manager attempts to submit the request, then the missing information is indicated. 3. Given the request has been submitted, when L&D receives it, then all mandatory information is available for review.
US-02	Requesting Manager	As a Requesting Manager, I want to see the L&D process owner assigned to my training request so that I know who to contact regarding the request.	1. Given a training request has been submitted, when an L&D process owner is assigned, then the owner's name and contact details are visible to the Requesting Manager. 2. Given the Requesting Manager needs information about the training request, when they check the request record, then they can identify the assigned L&D process owner. 3. Given the assigned process owner changes, when the change is recorded, then the new

			owner's details are visible to the Requesting Manager.
US-03	L&D Team	As an L&D Team Member, I want to see all required information in one request, so that I can assess the learning need efficiently.	1. Given a request is submitted, when the L&D team member opens it, then all mandatory information is available in one place. 2. Given information is missing, when the request is reviewed, then the missing information is clearly identifiable.
US-04	L&D Team	As an L&D Team Member, I want each request to have an assigned owner so that responsibilities are clear throughout the process.	1. Given a new request is received, when it is assigned, then an L&D process owner is recorded. 2. Given a request has an owner, when the request progresses through the process, then the owner remains responsible until closure unless ownership is reassigned.
US-05	L&D Team	As an L&D Team Member, I want to track the request status in one place so that I can see what has been completed and what is still outstanding.	1. Given a request progresses through the process, when a milestone is completed, then its status is updated. 2. Given an L&D team member opens a request, then the current status, owner and key dates are visible.
US-06	Participant	As a Participant, I want to receive clear training information and reminders so that I know when and where the training takes place and how to prepare.	1. Given a participant is confirmed, when the training is scheduled, then the participant receives the relevant training information. 2. Given the training date is approaching, then the participant receives the scheduled reminder.
US-07	Trainer / L&D Team Member	As a Trainer or L&D Team Member, I want to use a pre-training checklist so that key logistical and technical requirements are verified before delivery.	1. Given a training is scheduled, when preparation starts, then the checklist is available. 2. Given all preparation items are completed, when the final readiness check is performed, then the training can proceed to delivery. 3. Given an item is outstanding, when the readiness check is performed, then the issue is identified for resolution.
US-08	L&D Team	As an L&D Team Member, I want to record training outcomes and lessons learned so that future training initiatives can benefit from previous experience.	1. Given a training has been delivered, when the follow-up is completed, then outcomes and relevant observations are recorded. 2. Given improvement opportunities are identified, when the lessons learned are documented, then they are recorded in the standardized format.

KPIs

KPI	What it measures	Related Requirement
Request completeness rate	% of requests complete at first submission	BR-01
Training readiness rate	% trainings ready without last-minute issues	BR-04
Participant attendance rate	% of confirmed participants who attend the training	BR-06
Feedback score	Average participant feedback score	BR-07
Post-training follow-up completion	% trainings with documented follow-up	BR-07

SQL Analysis

1. How many training requests were submitted for each training category?

```
SELECT
    training_category,
    COUNT(*) AS request_count
FROM training_requests
GROUP BY training_category
ORDER BY request_count DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis shows which training categories generate the highest number of requests, helping identify the areas with the greatest training demand.

2. How has the number of training requests changed month over month?

```
WITH monthly_requests AS (
    SELECT
        DATE_TRUNC ('month', submission_date) AS month,
        COUNT (*) AS request_count
    FROM training_requests
    GROUP BY DATE_TRUNC ('month', submission_date)
)
SELECT
    month,
    request_count,
    LAG(request_count) OVER (ORDER BY month) AS previous_month_count,
    request_count – LAG (request_count) OVER (ORDER BY month) AS
    month_over_month_change
FROM monthly_requests
ORDER BY month;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis shows how training demand changes over time and highlights increases or decreases in monthly request volume.

3. What is the average number of participants per training category?

```
SELECT
    training_category,
    ROUND(AVG (participants),1) AS avg_participants
FROM training_requests
GROUP BY training_category
ORDER BY avg_participants DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies training categories with the highest average number of participants, supporting capacity and resource planning.

4. How many training requests were submitted less than 14 days before the scheduled date?

```
SELECT
    COUNT(*) AS request_count
FROM training_requests
WHERE training_date – submission_date BETWEEN 0 AND 13;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies requests submitted shortly before the scheduled training date, which may indicate limited planning and potential scheduling pressure.

5. Which three training categories have the longest average lead time?

```
SELECT
    training_category,
    AVG(training_date – submission_date) AS avg_lead_time_days
FROM training_requests
GROUP BY training_category
ORDER BY avg_lead_time_days DESC
LIMIT 3;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis compares the average time between request submission and training delivery across categories, helping identify differences in planning lead time.

6. What percentage of training requests require an external trainer?

```
SELECT
    100.0* SUM(
        CASE
            WHEN t.internal_external = 'External' THEN 1
            ELSE 0
        END
    ) / COUNT(*)
    AS external_trainer_percentage
FROM training_requests tr
JOIN trainers t
    ON tr.trainer_id = t.trainer_id;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis shows what proportion of training requests require external trainers, supporting decisions around external provider demand and resource planning.

7. Which process owners handled more than 5 training requests between January and June 2026?

```
SELECT process_owner,
    COUNT(*) AS request_count
FROM training_requests
WHERE submission_date BETWEEN '2026-01-01' AND '2026-06-30'
GROUP BY process_owner
HAVING COUNT(*) > 5
ORDER BY request_count DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies process owners handling a higher volume of requests during the selected period, helping assess workload distribution.

8. Which approval types have the highest proportion of requests remaining pending?

```
SELECT
    approval_type,
    100.0* SUM(
        CASE
            WHEN approval_status = 'Pending' THEN 1
            ELSE 0
        END
    ) / COUNT(*)
    AS pending_percentage
FROM approvals
GROUP BY approval_type
ORDER BY pending_percentage DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies approval types with the highest proportion of pending requests, helping identify potential approval bottlenecks.

9. Which approval types have the highest rejection rate?

```
WITH approval_stats AS (
    SELECT
        approval_type,
        COUNT(*) AS total_approvals,
        SUM(
            CASE
                WHEN approval_status = 'Rejected' THEN 1
                ELSE 0
            END
        ) AS rejected_approvals
FROM approvals
GROUP BY approval_type
)
SELECT
    approval_type,
    total_approvals,
    rejected_approvals,
    ROUND(
        100.0* rejected_approvals / total_approvals,
        2
    ) AS rejection_rate
FROM approval_stats
ORDER BY rejection_rate DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies approval types with the highest rejection rates, which may indicate areas where requirements or approval criteria need further review.

10. Which training categories have the highest total number of participants?

```
SELECT
    training_category,
    SUM(participants) AS total_participants
FROM training_requests
GROUP BY training_category
ORDER BY total_participants DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis identifies training categories reaching the largest total number of participants, helping assess overall training demand and resource requirements.

11. How do average participant satisfaction scores differ between external and internal trainers?

```
SELECT
    t.internal_external,
    ROUND(AVG(tf.satisfaction_score),2) AS avg_satisfaction
FROM training_feedback tf
JOIN training_requests tr
    ON tf.request_id = tr.request_id
JOIN trainers t
    ON tr.trainer_id = t.trainer_id
GROUP BY t.internal_external
ORDER BY avg_satisfaction DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis compares average participant satisfaction between internal and external trainers, providing insight into differences in training experience.

12. Do training sessions requiring post-training support have different satisfaction scores from those that do not?

```
SELECT
    tr.post_training_support,
    ROUND(AVG(tf.satisfaction_score),2) AS avg_satisfaction
FROM training_feedback tf
JOIN training_requests tr
    ON tf.request_id = tr.request_id
GROUP BY tr.post_training_support
ORDER BY avg_satisfaction DESC;
```

Business Interpretation:

The analysis compares satisfaction scores for training with and without post-training support, helping assess whether additional support is associated with participant satisfaction.

Recommendations & Expected Impact

- Reduced rework caused by incomplete requests,
- Improved visibility of request status,
- Reduced last-minute preparation issues,
- More consistent participant communication,
- Better reuse of lessons learned.

Requirements Traceability

Business Requirement	Functional Requirement	User Story	KPI
BR-01	FR-01,FR-02,FR-03	US-01,US-03	Request completeness rate
BR-02	FR-04,FR-05	US-02,US-04	-
BR-03	FR-06,FR-07	US-06	-
BR-04	FR-10,FR-11,FR-18	US-07	Training readiness rate
BR-05	FR-08,FR-09	US-05	-
BR-06	FR-12,FR-13	US-06	Participant attendance rate
BR-07	FR-14,FR-15,FR-16	US-08	Participant feedback score; Post-training follow-up completion rate
BR-08	FR-17	US-01	-

Assumptions & Constraints

Assumptions

- Training requests are submitted by managers or designated requesters.
- L&D owns the process after receiving the request.
- Internal and external training providers may be used.

Constraints

- Some training requests require additional business approval.
- External providers may have limited availability.
- Not all training needs can be addressed internally.

Out of scope

- Detailed procurement process for external providers,
- Trainer performance management,
- Financial accounting beyond training budget approval,
- Detailed LMS implementation,
- Evaluation of individual employee performance.